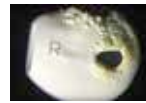




Driverless cars

Elon Musk has stated that commute with no input from a driver at all is coming soon in his future Tesla models. <https://digit.in/jan19-91>



Electrocuted by earphones

A 16-year old was electrocuted to death by earphones plugged to his phone making him the 4th such casualty. <https://digit.in/jan19-92>

In the 1880s, Heinrich Hertz proved that radio waves exist by building a simple transmitter and

receiver that only had a small gap between them. The equipment used for this was readily available, and anyone could easily replicate the experiment. A 20 year old Guglielmo Marconi began experimenting on radio transmitters based on the experiments of Hertz. In 1894, he demonstrated a doorbell that could be made to ring wirelessly at his own house. Soon, after he developed a reliable system for wireless telegraphy, for sending and receiving messages using the Morse code. In 1900, the Brazilian priest Landell de Moura demonstrated the transmission of voice over a distance of 8 kilometers using radio.

Around 1900, hobbyists magazines started providing designs for building equipment for transmitting and receiving radio signals. In 1904, the Electro Importing Company started selling assembled radio sets consisting of a simple transmitter and receiver. Without any regulations on the airwaves in place, the use of radio technologies was an open field for companies, the government, and individuals.

THE HAMS

Exactly why amateur radio enthusiasts are called ham operators is somewhat of a mystery. One of the earliest documented uses of the term is by amateur radio operators referring to themselves. In the early days after the discovery of wireless voice transmissions through the radio, the professionals were rather sluggish in adapting it. Boston, in the United States for example, experienced an early form of congestion in the form of multiple commercial radio stations being set up. These stations provided wireless telegraphy services, and sent out messages. The US Navy also had set up stations, for both wartime and peacetime activities. The regular operations of these "professional" stations were disrupted because of interference from hundreds



HAM RADIO

For over a century, "amateur" radio enthusiasts have actually been progressing the field of wireless communications

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of amateur radio stations set up by enthusiastic school boys.

This was a totally novel situation back then, with no existing regulations on how the public and the government should be allowed to use the limited amount of transmission capabilities through air. This was before precise instruments allowed simultaneous transmissions over multiple frequencies... any kind of radio traffic could block out the operations of another station, by using up the entire spectrum. The navy and commercial stations coordinated among themselves to keep out of each other's

way when they were transmitting, out of courtesy. However, all the schoolboys were not so courteous, and some would even ask the Navy to "beat it" when they were politely asked to refrain from using the stations while the Navy was doing so.

The Navy documented pages of mundane chatter between amateur radio operators, which involved jibes, discussions about shows, and enquiries about sharing equipment. A sample from these intercepted conversations between two amateur operators includes the line "Say, do you know the fellow who is putting up a new station out your way? I think he is a ham."

While the amateur radio community was using the word ham to describe